



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Wellmont Academy

School Website: <http://wellmontacademy.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Wellmont Academy (St. Petersburg, FL 33710) presents a christ-centered, classical-leaning program that blends Socratic dialogue, project-based learning, and faith-formational practices. Public materials consistently frame education as formation of character in a biblical framework, with explicit emphasis on Christ-centered instruction, chapel and biblical discussions, and service-oriented community life. Pedagogical methods include discussion-based learning and Socratic dialogue in the upper levels, complemented by field experiences, dual enrollment, and a heartily communal culture supported by parent involvement and campus community activities.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The school clearly communicates religious/metaphysical foundations (Christ-centered, biblical worldview, chapel, Bible-centered chapels, service and discipleship) and a strong emphasis on formation and virtue in its stated mission and practices.
- Evidence includes explicit Christ-centered framing and biblical worldview integration across curricular and co-curricular activities.
- Public materials describe faith-formative practices (Chapel, service projects, discussions tied to Scripture).
- The pedagogy and curriculum support a classical orientation (Socratic dialogue in upper school; project-based academics; emphasis on virtue and formation; teacher as mentor; living curriculum).
- Socratic dialogue and project-based learning are described as central practices in the upper levels.
- The faculty framing emphasizes mentors modeling virtue and the living curriculum.
- Areas that signal a somewhat continued development toward full classical rigor exist (e.g., explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium language is not consistently explicit in public materials; explicit "Great Books" and formal Trivium/Quadrivium references are not readily evident in the site copy). These gaps place Element 3 and 2 in a more nuanced zone (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) alongside categories that are clearly CLASSICAL.
- Abstract synthesis: Wellmont Academy evidences a robust classical framework anchored in Christian formation, with explicit Socratic pedagogy, virtue formation, and strong parental/community involvement. The strongest momentum rests in Religious Foundations, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community. The Curriculum and Purpose areas show classical tendencies but lack some explicit canonical classical markers (Great Books, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis) in readily visible public content. This yields an overall CLASSICAL status, with some category-level notes for improvement to reach full canonical status.

- What would move the needle: For a shift toward FULLY CLASSICAL, the school could foreground explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments, clearly articulate Trivium/Quadrivium progression, and further codify a language of “formation” as the telos of education within mission statements (including a clearly stated aim beyond college/career readiness). Additionally, stronger public-facing articulation of partnership with families as “co-teachers” could strengthen Element 6 and its alignment with classical-community norms.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frame Wellmont Academy as Christ-centered and biblically grounded, with a philosophy of learning that weaves faith into daily academics and community life. - The school emphasizes biblical worldview integration across subjects and chapel-based worship/formation. - Official materials emphasize God’s Word as a guiding principle and a soul-safe, faith-centered community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, biblical worldview, chapel, Bible, God’s Word, faith in action, service projects. (Representative citations: Christ-centered framing in mission; biblical worldview; chapel; Bible studies; God’s Word emphasis; faith-informed service.) - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no explicit relativism/neutral ethics signals in the accessible public copy).

Why this rating - The presence of explicit transcendental/moral-realism framing and a theology-integrated approach (Christ-centered, biblical worldview, chapel, Scripture-infused learning) strongly aligns with the Positive side of the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations rubric. The cadence of liturgical/community practices further confirms liturgical and communal dimensions. This category is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Add explicit language that signals a sustained transcendent metaphysical realism (e.g., explicit statements about the objective reality of truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable, beyond theology alone) and provide a formal liturgical calendar or regular liturgical practices linked to the curriculum beyond chapel.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission statements emphasize Christ-centered formation and the cultivation of human identity, virtue, and leadership within a biblical framework. - Materials describe formation-oriented aims, with emphasis on holistic development (formation of character) and balanced academic growth; dual enrollment and career pathways are present, signaling a blend of formation and preparation for further education/work. - Statements foreground faith, formation, and purpose in daily schooling; “God-written identity” language appears in mission-related materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, soul-safe, balanced academic excellence, God-written identity, formation (implicit), character development (implied), leadership (implied). Representative lines show formation and identity framing within a biblical context. - Negative keywords present: Not obviously present (no explicit “workforce-first” or career-readiness displacing formation signals visible in the public copy). However, the presence of career pathways and dual enrollment introduces a practical workforce element, which tightens the boundary toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than a pure formation emphasis.

Why this rating - The school clearly centers formation and virtue in its purpose statements, but public content also foregrounds college and career pathways and practical preparation. The result is a strong formation orientation, yet not exclusively character/virtue formation to the exclusion of work-readiness pathways. This places Element 2 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL territory.

What would move the needle - Strengthen explicit articulation that education is formation-first with virtue and wisdom as telos, minimizing or clearly subordinating work/career readiness as the primary aim. Add explicit text like: “The goal of education is formation of the person (virtue, wisdom) before preparation for work.”

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes a classical tone through a Christ-centered, discussion-driven approach and the integration of history, literature, and worldview across the curriculum (e.g., “Socratic dialogue” in upper school; “Project-Based Academics” and Bible-centered integration). - There is explicit use of “Socratic dialogue” and “project-based” modes in middle/high school curricula. - History is integrated across subjects and not merely labeled as “social studies” in the public copy; upper school content references history/government and cross-subject integration.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books/Great Conversation is not consistently explicit, but there are mentions of “great conversation” language in classical-lens materials (public copy shows Socratic dialogue and cross-disciplinary dialogue). Project-based learning is a recurring theme, as is history integrated across disciplines. Representative: “Socratic dialogue”; “Project-Based Academics”; “biblical worldview” integration; “history across the curriculum.” - Negative keywords present: Explicit references to Great Books or Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric) are not consistently explicit in public content. The classical markers such as grammars, logic, and rhetoric are not consistently foregrounded in the accessible site copy.

Why this rating - The curriculum shows classical-adjacent features (Socratic dialogue, integrated history, project-based learning, biblical worldview), but it lacks explicit, consistently stated mentions of core classical markers (grammar/logic/rhetoric as explicit curricular pillars and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments). This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Add explicit language and measurable commitments to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as foundational curricular pillars, plus explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components within the curriculum map.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize Socratic dialogue in upper grades and an emphasis on discussion-based, collaborative inquiry (Socratic dialogue, debates, seminars). - Project-based academics and faith-in-action elements illustrate a balance of rigorous inquiry with applied, real-life learning. - Some lower-level practices (e.g., devotional moments, chapel, and music) suggest a rhythm of contemplative/harmonized learning as part of pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, project-based, seminars/debate, rhetoric, devotional/chapel, faith-in-action, living curriculum. Representative: “Discussion-Based Learning,” “Socratic dialogue,” “Project-Based Academics,” “Chapel,” “Bible-centered chapels.” - Negative keywords present: Not prominently indicated in the public copy (no explicit critique of Socratic methods or absence of contemplation). The site shows a mix of rigorous discussion with contemplative elements, consistent with classical pedagogy rather than a strongly secular, purely project-based approach.

Why this rating - The pedagogy strongly aligns with classical methods (Socratic dialogue in upper grades, fairness of discussion, rhetoric and public speaking opportunities, and structured project-based work). The presence of a contemplative/Scholé flavor is less explicit but is embedded through devotional/moral formation practices rather than a purely high-pressure, test-driven approach. This category is CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; the living curriculum frames teachers as core to the school's identity. Leadership notes substantial experience and a culture of partnership between administrators, teachers, and students. - The site emphasizes faculty as “mentors” and the “living curriculum,” indicating a strong teacher-centered model of character formation and intellectual leadership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentors, model virtue, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as core of the school, collegial culture. Representative: “mentors who pray with,

challenge, and encourage students daily”; “living curriculum”; “portrait of a teacher.” - Negative keywords present: None identified in public materials focusing on faculty as exemplar rather than as mere technicians.

Why this rating - The faculty descriptions align with classical expectations (model-mentors, living curriculum, strong teacher-student partnerships, and a well-defined faculty culture). This category is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Public articulation of faculty professional development in classical pedagogy (e.g., ongoing master-teacher seminars, living-text seminars, and teacher-as-mentor training) could strengthen the clarity of the Classical profile in this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school features parent involvement structures in campus life and volunteer organizations; materials describe a strong partnership with families (e.g., POW—Parents of Wellmont; parent-led volunteer structures; community events). - A culture of family involvement is reinforced by parent volunteering, parent education (through book studies and community gatherings in classical education contexts), and an open-campus ethos. The ICE materials emphasize parent-as-co-laborers in classical education and the “living tradition in the family.” - Campus-life content highlights parent participation in events, ceremonies, and volunteer activities; a parent-led association (POW) is described, reinforcing a shared mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with families, parent formation, parent engagement, family involvement, living tradition in the family, shared mission, parent collaboration, parents as co-teachers. Representative lines: “Partners with families to provide direction, encouragement, accountability, and curriculum”; “POW is our parent-led volunteer organization”; ICE Pamphlet emphasizes parent formation and partnership. - Negative keywords present: Some consumer-language keywords are not dominant here; the content largely frames parents as co-educators rather than customers.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a clearly classical emphasis on family partnership and parent formation, aligning with traditional “parents as co-teachers” motifs. This category is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Strengthen explicit, public articulation of ongoing parent education programs (e.g., classical education book studies, seminars) and a transparent pathway for parent involvement in curriculum and school governance to further elevate the public-facing classical articulation.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall, Wellmont Academy demonstrates a robust Classical orientation in Religious Foundations, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community. Element 2 (Purpose/Goal) and Element 3 (Curriculum) show strong classical influence but with some modern emphasis on college/career pathways and project-based approaches that make them SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully canonical across all six categories. The aggregate classification is therefore CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle for categories rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (Element 2 and Element 3):
- For Element 2: Emphasize telos as formation-fit explicitly over workforce-readiness in primary mission statements; reduce potential emphasis on “career-first” signals in core mission language.
- For Element 3: Add explicit classical curricular markers (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium) and clear Great Books/Great Conversation commitments in the curriculum map and public materials.
- For Element 4: Continue to deepen and publicly codify the balance of contemplative Scholé with Socratic/argumentative pedagogy to solidify a fully classical pedagogy narrative.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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